

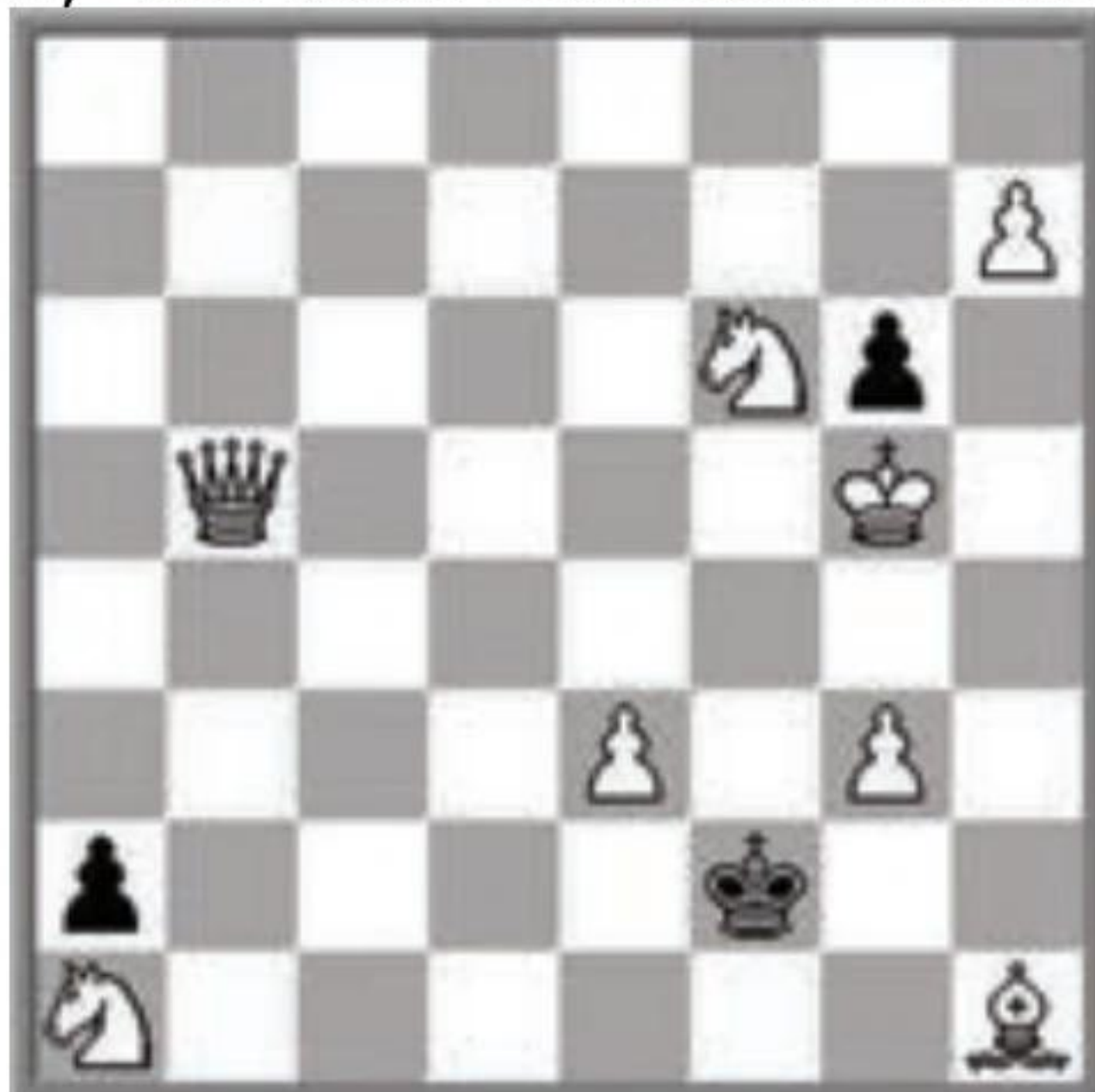
On solving three-movers

By C.G.S.Narayanan

'Compared to two-movers the extra move in three-movers introduces a new order of complexity into the solver's desk. Two-movers can always be solved by trial and error in fairly short time. But applying the same method to three-movers could take hours. The distinction between zugzwang and threat problems is of less significance' wrote GM John Nunn, one of World's great solvers, in his 'Solving in style' where Nunn analyses the humour in the following composition.

E. Zepler

3HM, Thematuriers Dredhnern 1930



Mate in three moves

Black can move only his King, but there are four flights available. Black's most prominent defences already have mates provided. 1...Kxg3 2.Qe2 Kh3 3.Qg2; 1...Kg1 2.Ng4 Kxh1 3.Qf1; 1...Ke1 2.Ne4 Kd1 3.Qf1; 1..Kxe3 2.Ne4 Kd4 3.Nc2 the best of the four mates. Non-checking second move continuations are considered praiseworthy. A waiting move is sufficient to solve the problem but it is surprisingly difficult to find one! Now the solvers' attention is drawn to the WPh7. The argument seems suspicious as WPh7 takes no part in the set play and so why should it not promote? Searching carefully reveals the trap. 1.h8=Q/B? Kxe3!

2.Ne4 stalemates. 1.h8=Q/R? Kxg3! When Qe2 delivers another stalemate exploiting white's newly acquired control of h3. **So the key must be 1.h8 N!**

W. Shinkman

Dubuque Chess Journal 1890



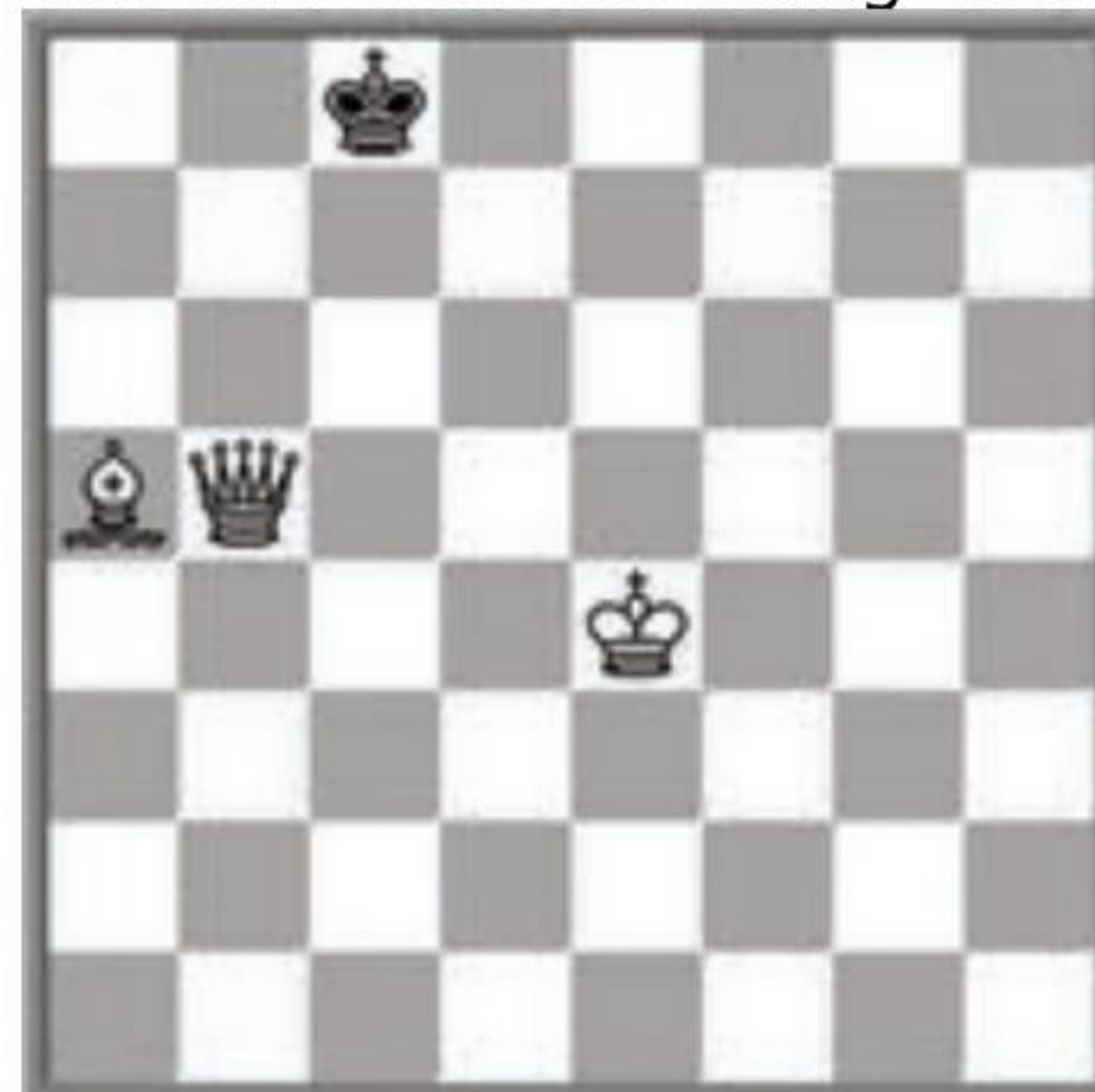
Mate in three moves

In the above diagram it is not hard to see which piece makes the key in the above diagram. WBh5 is out of play all the more after 1..Kb6. It is tempting to put the WB on g4 behind the WQ black replies 1..Kb6 after which we find that wB finds no useful purpose. The likely key is **1.Be2!** with threat Qe6+, Qd6+ Qc8+ 1...Kb7 2.Qc8+ Kxc8 3.Ba6 while 1...Kb6 leads to the echo 2.Qa5+ Kxa5 3.Bc7

A miniature three-mover for solving

W. Shinkman

Offiziers Schachzeitung 1905



Mate in three moves

Solution to problem for solving in the article 'The duel feast': Tries 1.Kd5? c6+! 1.Ke5? cxd6! 1.Kd4? c5+ **Key 1.Kf4!**

Readers may send in their queries to cgsnarayanan@hotmail.com